

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

THURSDAY, JANUARY 23, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION

Taking aim at DEI: The White House has moved to end affirmative action in federal contracting and directed that federal DEI staff eventually be laid off. **Business, Page 2**

Eying retribution: Fresh from being freed by Trump's sweeping grants of clemency, two notorious far-right leaders want president to seek revenge. **Nation & World**

Halting watchdog agency: The White House is moving to paralyze a bipartisan group that investigates rights violations in national security activities. **Nation & World**

DOJ targets sanctuary law backers

Charges urged for state, local officials impeding the administration's crackdown on immigration

By **Alanna Durkin Richer and Eric Tucker**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Justice Department has ordered federal prosecutors to investigate state or local officials who they believe are interfering with the Trump administration's crackdown on immigration, saying they could face

criminal charges, in an apparent warning to the dozens of so-called sanctuary jurisdictions across America.

The memo, from acting Deputy Attorney General Emil Bove, also instructs the Justice Department's civil division to work with a newly formed Sanctuary Cities Enforcement Working Group to identify state and local laws and policies

that "threaten to impede" the Trump administration's immigration efforts and potentially challenge them in court.

The memo signals a sharp turn about in priorities from President Joe Biden's Democratic administration, with prosecutors told in no uncertain terms that they will be on the front lines of an administration-wide effort to crack down on illegal immigration and border crime and that they are expected to carry out the policy vision of President Donald Trump's Republican

White House when it comes to violent crimes, the threat of international gangs and drug trafficking.

"Indeed, it is the responsibility of the Justice Department to defend the Constitution, and accordingly, to lawfully execute the policies that the American people elected President Trump to implement," wrote Bove, who prior to joining the administration was part of the legal team that defended Trump

Turn to DOJ, Page 10

In city, a vow to protect migrants

One day after Trump threw out policies that limited immigration arrests at sensitive locations, such as churches, schools and hospitals, leaders of those institutions scrambled to come up with plans to protect Chicago's migrants where they once felt safest. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Ranked choice voting on table

System could boost election fairness, but it faces a steep climb

By **A.D. Quig, Tess Kenny and Richard Requena**
Chicago Tribune

As political division and mistrust surfaced again this inauguration week for Americans, some suburbs and Illinois towns are looking to put into action a system that proponents hope can boost fairness and increase trust in the election process: ranked choice voting.

Evanston, Skokie, Oak Park, Naperville, Berwyn and downstate Peoria have favored or are exploring the concept, with voters in Evanston and Oak Park overwhelmingly approving it at the polls.

While proponents hope voters in Evanston and Oak Park, or possibly other locales, will walk into voting booths as early as 2026 or 2027 and choose their candidates from a ranked choice voting ballot, their enthusiasm is facing headwinds. The Cook County clerk's office, which runs elections in the county's suburbs,

Turn to Voting, Page 2



BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Big task, big optimism

New Bears head coach Ben Johnson greets quarterback Caleb Williams before being introduced on Wednesday at Halas Hall. After 17 candidate interviews over 12 days, the Bears hired Johnson from the Detroit Lions, where he was the offensive coordinator. After a bumpy rookie season in which Williams had two head coaches, two play callers and three offensive coordinators, the Bears put in place a coach they believe can help the quarterback grow into his NFL potential for years to come in Chicago. **Coverage in Chicago Sports**

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

In closing, feds cast doubt on testimony

Prosecutors: Former speaker put 'facade' on the witness stand

By **Jason Meisner, Megan Crepeau and Ray Long**
Chicago Tribune

Prosecutors in the historic corruption trial of former House Speaker Michael Madigan on Wednesday attacked the credibility of the defense's star witness: Madigan himself.

"What you heard on the witness stand was a facade," Assistant U.S. Attorney Julia Schwartz said during more than 2½ hours of the prosecution's closing argument, taking the jury through some of the more



Former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan leaves Chicago's Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Wednesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

damaging wiretapped recordings and emails that she said repeatedly showed Madigan was in on schemes to enrich himself and enhance his power.

Despite his repeated and rigorous denials from the witness stand this month, Schwartz said Madigan, the most powerful politician in the state and head of the Democratic Party of Illinois, knew full well that ComEd was secretly funneling hundreds of thousands of dollars to some of his top associates in a bid to influence him on the utility giant's

legislation.

Schwartz said Madigan wasn't just involved in the scheme, and he was not just looped in by his co-defendant Michael McClain. He was steering the whole thing. "Legislation should not be bought, but that's what was happening here," Schwartz said. "And Madigan knew that because he and McClain set it up that way."

Closing arguments in Madigan's case finally got underway Wednesday afternoon after

Turn to Madigan, Page 4

Planned Parenthood announces closures

Despite surge in activity since abortion ruling, 4 Ill. clinics to shutter, including 1 in Chicago

By **Angie Leventis Lourgos**
Chicago Tribune

Citing a "financial shortfall," Planned Parenthood of Illinois announced Wednesday — on the 52nd anniversary of Roe v. Wade — that it will be closing four clinics across the state, including one on Chicago's South Side.

The health center shutdowns come as Illinois is already grappling with a surge in patients traveling here from other states for abortion care after the U.S. Supreme Court overturned the landmark decision Roe v. Wade in June 2022, ending federal abortion rights.

The number of abortion seekers coming to Illinois — long known as a haven for reproductive health access nationwide — has skyrocketed over the past few years. Illinois clinicians provided more abortions for out-of-state patients than any other state in the nation in 2023, the first full

year without Roe, according to data from the Guttmacher Institute, a research group that supports abortion rights.

Roughly 37,350 out-of-state patients traveled here for abortion care in 2023, more than triple the nearly 11,150 counted in 2020, according to estimates from the Guttmacher Institute. This was more out-of-state patients than any other state that year, including those with larger populations such as California and New York, the data showed.

Many reproductive rights advocates fear abortion restrictions around the country will only intensify following President Donald Trump's inauguration Monday.

One of the first notable changes after the new administration assumed control was the dismantling of the government website "reproductiverights.gov." The

Turn to Closures, Page 3

